

# MAJID MUMTAZ, CIA, ACA, FCCA

*Group Director of Internal Audit & GRC*

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## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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Group Director of Internal Audit and GRC with over 20 years of GCC experience, known for closing the gap between governance frameworks and business reality. Trusted advisor to Boards and Audit Committees, with a mandate covering complex special investigations, ethics programme ownership, and cybersecurity vendor governance. Integrates AI, machine learning, and deep learning into the audit process to move from statistical sampling to full-population coverage.

This work has recovered AED 7.7M in revenue leakage, neutralized SAR 15M in hidden M&A risk, and strengthened governance across complex multi-sector GCC portfolios. Has consistently moved internal audit from a compliance cost centre into a commercial risk intelligence function.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Veritux Consulting Network

Dubai, UAE

*Principal, Internal Audit & Risk Advisory*

*Jul 2025 – Present*

- **Institutional Transformation:** Works with CFOs and Boards to establish financial governance structures across multi-sector operations, addressing regulatory risk and improving financial control environments.
- **Forensic Audit & ML Risk Engine:** Deployed an ML risk engine to monitor SAR 500M+ in CapEx and OpEx across a KSA real estate developer's residential and commercial portfolios; identified procurement and payment anomalies that recovered SAR 3.2M annually, at a coverage level conventional sampling could not match.
- **National Market Readiness:** Develops Board-level financial charters and reporting frameworks for Saudi Family Offices, meeting Saudi CMA requirements for institutional capital market participation.

### Kitopi (Tech-Driven Unicorn)

Dubai, UAE

*Director of GRC & Internal Audit*

*Jun 2022 – May 2025*

- **Operational Risk Assurance:** Built an audit assurance framework using ML anomaly detection and Deep Learning OCR pipelines to process high-volume manual invoice bundles, moving from statistical sampling to full-population coverage. Reduced fraud incidents by 78% during a 340% surge in transaction volume.
- **IT Governance & Cybersecurity Assurance:** Designed the ITGC framework for a rapidly scaling cloud platform; directed group-wide cybersecurity assessments and penetration testing, translating technical vulnerability findings into Board-level risk briefings and remediation plans.
- **IPO Governance Readiness:** Built the ICFR programme from scratch for the pre-IPO roadmap; EY's external readiness attestation confirmed zero material weaknesses and zero significant deficiencies.
- **Ethics Programme & Whistleblowing:** Ran the Group's ethics and whistleblowing programme end-to-end: selected NAVEX EthicsPoint through a competitive vendor evaluation, designed the case management framework and escalation protocol, and reported case status directly to the Audit Committee; led executive engagement on investigations and corrective actions.
- **Special Investigations:** Led a number of sensitive internal investigations, including a CAPEX governance breach inquiry; managed investigation design, evidence handling, and executive reporting while maintaining auditor independence throughout.

- **Commercial Integrity Monitoring:** Recovered AED 3.2M in vendor overcharges and neutralized AED 4.5M in future exposure through automated, continuous monitoring.
- **Data-Driven Audit Transformation:** Built a Python and Pandas automation suite for continuous transaction monitoring across seven audit domains, covering flagging logic, workflow routing, and exception reporting; shifted the audit function from periodic reviews to ongoing, real-time monitoring.

## Al-Faisaliah Group (JSC)

Group Director of Internal Audit & Risk

Riyadh, KSA

Nov 2016 – May 2022

- **Digital Governance Transformation:** Directed audit oversight of a Group-wide G-Suite to Microsoft 365 migration, ensuring data integrity, security resilience, and post-migration compliance across a highly diversified portfolio.
- **Cybersecurity Vendor Governance:** Led the competitive selection and onboarding of AT&T as Group MSSP, overseeing vendor evaluation, contractual terms, and ongoing SLA performance; the engagement substantially hardened the Group's security posture and data protection frameworks.
- **M&A Due Diligence:** Led internal due diligence on a \$127M acquisition, identifying SAR 15M in undisclosed litigation exposure; findings were used to renegotiate terms before closing.
- **Special Investigations:** Led multiple special investigations across the Group's portfolio, covering procurement irregularities, supplier conduct, and related-party concerns; managed each case from intake and forensic review through to Board-level reporting and remediation tracking, independent of management.
- **Enterprise Risk Management (ERM):** Built a Board-commissioned ERM framework consolidating risk exposure across four sectors, giving the Group its first unified view of portfolio-wide risk.
- **Fraud Prevention & Detection:** Generated SAR 4.2M in annual savings through predictive ML monitoring of procurement and supplier payment processes.
- **Function Professionalization:** Grew the internal audit team from 3 to 20 professionals and achieved the IIA 'Generally Conforms' rating on external quality assessment.

## EARLIER CAREER & BIG 4 FOUNDATION

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|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Manager, Internal Audit   <b>McDonald's Saudi Arabia</b>     | 2014 – 2016 |
| Internal Audit Manager   <b>KPMG (Qatar)</b>                 | 2011 – 2013 |
| AVP, Internal Audit   <b>BMA Asset Management</b>            | 2010 – 2011 |
| Audit Manager   <b>Ernst &amp; Young (Karachi, Pakistan)</b> | 2004 – 2009 |

## SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Teaching an Algorithm to Filter False Flags, *IIA Internal Auditor Magazine (Voices)*
- The Risk of Algorithmic Entropy: When AI Models Age Faster Than Evolving Fraud, *Consultancy ME*
- AI Authorization Is Not AI Accountability, *GRC Report*
- The CFO Is the Audit Independence Risk You're Not Managing, *GRC Report*
- Keeping Risk Registers Relevant, *ACCA AB Magazine*
- FCPA Compliance Programs Are Missing Important Nuances about how Bribery Works in the Persian Gulf, *Corporate Compliance Insights*

## EDUCATION, CREDENTIALS & TECH STACK

**Core Credentials:** CIA, ACA, FCCA | **Degree:** B.Com (Karachi University)

**Audit Domains & Frameworks:** IIA Standards | COSO ERM & ISO 31000 | ICFR / SOX | COBIT | ISO 27001 | NIST CSF | Third-Party Risk | Forensic Investigations

**Tech Stack:** Python/ML/DL, Pandas, Deep Learning OCR | ITGC & Cloud Governance, O365/G-Suite  
| Pen-Test & MSSP Vendor Governance | NAVEX EthicsPoint | SAP, Oracle

**Executive Certifications:**

- Certificate in Disruptive Strategy (Harvard Business School Online)
- Enterprise Risk Management Certificate (COSO)
- Information Systems Auditing & IT Governance (HKUST)
- Machine Learning with Python (IBM)
- Forensic Accounting and Fraud Examination (WVU)
- Risk Management Specialization (NYIF)